

Citations

In academic work, writers have to cite their sources. This is to prove that they have not copied another scholar's writing, taken credit for someone else's ideas, or made up information. A citation needs to be added if another writer's direct words have been quoted, or his or her

original ideas or findings are described. Statistics also need to be cited. There are several citation systems to choose from; however, the same system must be used throughout a piece of writing.

▷ Numbering system

In a numbering system, a small number is placed after each fact or quotation that needs to be cited. This corresponds to a numbered source placed at the bottom of the page, called a footnote. The details are repeated in the bibliography at the end of the work.

Pizza purists argue that pizzas should only be topped with tomatoes, herbs, and sometimes mozzarella. According to a prominent Italian food writer, "There are only two types of pizza—Marinara and Margherita. That is all I serve."¹

1. Gennaro Rossi, *The Perfect Pizza* (London: Pizza Press, 2010), 9.

The title of the book is written in italics.

The location and name of the publisher appear in parentheses, separated by a colon. A publisher's name is followed by a comma and the publication date.

The specific page reference(s) should also be included. There is no need to include abbreviations such as *p.* or *pp.*

▷ Parenthetical system

In a parenthetical system, citations appear in parentheses within the text. In North America, the two most common parenthetical systems are MLA style (shown here) and APA style, named after the Modern Language Association and the American Psychological Association, respectively.

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The last name of the author is included because it is not mentioned in the surrounding text. If the author's name is mentioned in the text, there is no need to include it in the citation.

The exact page reference is always included.

The period is placed outside the quotation marks, after the parentheses.

▷ "Works Cited" list

When using a parenthetical system, the rest of the information about the sources needs to be included in a "Works Cited" list at the end of the assignment. Unlike a bibliography, this list only includes the sources that have been quoted or paraphrased; it does not list books used for background research.

Romano, Silvio. *The History of Italian Cooking*. New York: Food Books, 1982. Print.

Rossi, Gennaro. *The Perfect Pizza*. London: Pizza Press, 2010. Print.

The sources should be listed alphabetically by the author's last name.

The title is italicized.

The publisher's details are separated by a colon.

End each entry with the medium of publication.